



iPad Pro 5G

Following the launch of 5G-ready iPhones this year, the iPad Pro might also be getting 5G support. <https://digit.in/dec20-59>



Leica Q2 Monochrom

Leica's latest black-and-white-only camera comes with fast autofocus and Bluetooth connectivity. <https://digit.in/dec20-60>

Apple iPad Air 2020

All the right improvements

The iPad Air 2020 borrows a lot of elements from the iPad Pro making it a more viable option for those looking for some "Pro" features, but don't want to spend the extra cash on an iPad Pro. So, let's dive in and see what the 2020 iPad Air is all about.

Build and design

The design philosophy of the iPad has evolved over the years. The bezels have grown thinner and this time around, Touch ID has been integrated into the power button. The iPad Air might have curved edges, but its borders are sharp. It has a very industrial design, more in line with the iPad Pro. While the 2019 iPad Air had a more rounded design at the back, this one is a bit sharper.

At the back, we have a single 12MP camera and no LiDAR sensor like found on the Pros. When held in landscape mode, you also have the connector on the top for the 2nd Gen Apple Pencil. There is also a connector at the back to connect this to the Magic keyboard. The iPad Air 2020 forgoes the headphone jack found on the 2019 iPad Air. It has a USB-C port, yes Apple has moved away from the lightning port, so if you have USB-C headphones, it should be fine.

Magic Keyboard

The Magic Keyboard holds the iPad in place magnetically and gives you the illusion that it is floating. The Magic Keyboard has a USB-C port. The keyboard and trackpad are the true stars here. Since this is a tablet cover, the keyboard is smaller than what we'd find on a MacBook Air, but once you get used to it, it is a breeze to type on. The keys are backlit as well. The trackpad works exactly like you'd expect.

The Magic Keyboard has a cutout for the camera and it has the square cutout since it is compatible with the Air as well as the Pro.



Display and audio performance

The display on the 10.9-inch iPad Air is rich and vibrant. It supports Dolby Vision and considering the library of streaming content on offer in Dolby Vision, this display is a treat for binge-watchers.

Even under direct sunlight, the display is readable for checking mail, reading books off Kindle and getting some work done. Watch movies under the sun, and the display does get reflective. Even with gaming, the tablet is comfortable to hold and wide enough for a good grip, although playing CoD Mobile for more than an hour can get tiring. Since you can connect a Bluetooth controller to the tablet, and most games support a controller, the device works well for gaming.

Coming to the audio, this iPad can get loud. Loud enough that you don't need to keep it at 100 percent volume to enjoy a movie or TV show. While the 2019 iPad Air also only had 2 speakers, they were on the same side. The 2020 iPad Air offers stereo separation.

Performance

When it comes to everyday perfor-

mance the tablet performed impressively without any stutters. Jumping between apps to multitask is easy and seamless, but it still lacks the fluidity found on a desktop.

The iPad Air 2020 is also compatible with the 2nd generation Apple Pencil. In terms of latency, its response is almost instantaneous.

If you are looking for a portable device to play games, watch movies, get some work done, have access to thousands and thousands of apps, read eBooks on, read comics on, the iPad Air 2020 can do it all.

Battery life

Apple still claims the "up to 10 hours of surfing the web on Wi-Fi or watching video" and for the most part, this holds true. To put things into perspective, the battery fell about 10 percent in one hour for streaming content off YouTube. You could easily play CoD: Mobile on this device for 6 hours straight before thinking of looking for the charger.

Verdict

So should you purchase the iPad Air 2020? Like

we said last year, the answer to that question honestly depends on your requirement and how you plan to use the device. If you are only going to consume content from OTT platforms, play some games, social network, email, FaceTime and want a foot in the door of the Apple ecosystem, then the 8th gen iPad is enough for you. If you need a device with a bit more speed and horsepower, then you can consider the Air.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 10.9-inch Liquid Retina display with 2360 x 1640 pixels resolution | PLATFORM: Apple A14 Bionic | RAM: 4GB | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 64GB/256GB | EXPANDABLE STORAGE: NA | SIM SUPPORT: eSIM | USB-C: Yes | 3.5MM JACK: No | THICKNESS: 6.1 mm | OS: iOS 14 | REAR CAMERA: 12MP | FRONT CAMERA: 7MP | SPEAKERS: 4 | BLUETOOTH: v5.0

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